

NEWS RELEASE

TANDY CORPORATION/RADIO SHACK

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DATE: June 24, 1983

RELEASE NO: RS-83-185

SUBJECT: TRS-XENIX

XENIX Multi-user is standard operating system on Radio Shack
TRS-80® Model 16 Microcomputer

Radio Shack, a division of Tandy Corporation, offers the XENIX™ multi-user operating system developed by Microsoft Corporation as the standard operating system on the TRS-80® Model 16 microcomputer. A Model 16 equipped with XENIX can be expanded by the addition of one or two low cost terminals to let as many as three users operate programs simultaneously, a function previously available only on larger, more expensive computers.

XENIX gives the Model 16 full multi-user, multi-tasking abilities without any degradation in performance. Each user may operate a different applications program or may share the same programs and data, such as accounting, inventory control, word processing or electronic filing. All users also share the same peripherals, such as a printer, attached to the Model 16.

Radio Shack offers several multi-user applications software packages for XENIX equipped Model 16's including a full compliment of interactive accounting packages and a high capacity inventory control system. Additionally, Radio Shack offers Microsoft Multiplan in a specially developed version for the Model 16 that supports multi-user operation. Multiplan is an advanced spreadsheet program for planning and modeling.

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XENIX will operate on any TRS-80 Model 16 equipped with 256K of memory and a hard disk and on similarly equipped Model II microcomputers that have had a Model 16 upgrade kit installed. All applications software currently offered by Radio Shack for the Model 16 can be moved to the XENIX system insuring an upgrade path for current Model 16 owners.

XENIX was developed by the Microsoft Corporation of Bellevue, Washington and is derived from the UNIX™ ("UNIX is a trademark of Bell Laboratories) operating system and is fully licensed by AT&T. The XENIX operating system includes many sophisticated features including tree-structured directories, device-independent I/O, chaining of program input and output, and foreground and background program execution.

William Gates, executive vice president and Chairman of Microsoft commented, "The large base of Model 16's will more than double the number of XENIX based systems and ensure that many quality multi-user applications will be developed. Radio Shack's endorsement of XENIX makes it the first major 68000 system with quality multi-user support."

According to Ed Juge, director of computer merchandising, business computer products, for Radio Shack, "XENIX makes the Model 16 an extremely competitively priced product for small business applications, offering users powerful upward expandability. This will set a standard for operating systems for multi-user microcomputers."

In addition to the basic (core) XENIX operating system supplied with all Model 16's, Radio Shack offers a XENIX development system

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including the C language for programmers. Radio Shack also offers a version of Microsoft BASIC that has been specially developed for use with XENIX on computers using the 68000 microprocessor.

The TRS-80 Model 16 Microcomputer with XENIX is available from Radio Shack Computer Centers, and participating Radio Shack Stores and dealers.

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XENIX and Multiplan are trademarks of Microsoft Corporation.